CHAYAN PANCHAL

Junior SOC Analyst · Detection Engineering · DFIR · HTB CDSA

HTB CDSA | SOC Analyst Path · 18/18 modules | Google Cybersecurity Certified

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity practitioner with five years of hands-on lab practice (HTB, since 2021) focused on security operations, detection engineering and digital forensics. **HTB Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA)** — passed the practical exam by investigating two independent Active Directory intrusions end to end and delivering a commercial-grade incident report. Completed **HTB Academy's SOC Analyst path in full (18 modules)** and the Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate. Writes detections in Sigma, KQL, SPL and Suricata mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and builds tooling in Python and SQL. Seeking a junior SOC/security operations role where I can contribute immediately while developing production experience. Open to relocation or remote work.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM & Log Analysis	Splunk (SPL), Elastic Stack / Kibana (KQL, EQL), Microsoft Sentinel, Wazuh · correlation searches, dashboards, alert triage
Detection Engineering	Sigma and YARA rule authoring, KQL / SPL / Suricata rule writing, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, false-positive analysis, detection tuning and baselining
DFIR	Windows event-log and Sysmon investigation, timeline reconstruction, attack-chain analysis, containment scoping, NIST incident-handling lifecycle, malware analysis, incident reporting
Endpoint & AD	Sysmon, Windows Security event logs, PowerShell, Active Directory attacks and defences, EDR/XDR concepts, Microsoft Defender
Network Security	Suricata, Snort 3, Zeek, Wireshark, tcpdump, JA3 fingerprinting · TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/S, SMTP, VPN, firewall rules
Programming	Python (advanced — automation, log parsing, GUI apps), SQL (MySQL, security-focused queries), Bash, PowerShell
Frameworks	MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-30/800-171, PASTA, PCI-DSS, GDPR awareness
Systems	Linux CLI, Windows administration, IAM and access control, OpenSSL, JavaScript deobfuscation

CERTIFICATIONS

HTB Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA) — *Hack The Box* — Sep 2026

Credential ID HTBCERT-88304FEA1D · Verify on HTB Academy

- Hands-on practical exam: investigated two independent Active Directory intrusions end to end using SIEM and host evidence, then delivered a commercial-grade incident report with executive summary and technical analysis of every kill-chain stage.

SOC Analyst Job-Role Path — *HTB Academy* — Completed in full

- 18 module-completion badges and 25 Academy achievements.

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate — *Coursera* — Mar 2026

Credential ID GBEGPUJOSIJ7 · 9 courses · 15 hands-on labs covering Linux, SQL, Python automation, network security and incident response

PROJECTS

signal › over › noise — *SOC detection-engineering portfolio* — akatetron.github.io/signal-over-noise

Wrote **ten detection rules** in Sigma, KQL, SPL and Suricata covering 12 MITRE ATT&CK techniques. Each rule includes a false-positive profile and tuning notes.

DETECTION	LANGUAGE	ATT&CK
LSASS memory access — credential dumping	Sigma	T1003.001
Parent PID spoofing	Sigma	T1134.004
DLL search-order hijacking	Sigma	T1574.001
WMI lateral movement	Sigma	T1047 · T1021.003

Shadow-copy deletion — ransomware precursor	Sigma	T1490
Disabled-account logon attempts	KQL	T1078
Service-account RDP usage	KQL	T1021.001
Password spraying	KQL	T1110.003
Privileged-group membership changes	SPL	T1098
C2 beaconing	Suricata	T1071 · T1573

- *Multi-stage intrusion reconstruction:* rebuilt a five-stage attack chain from raw Sysmon and Windows Security logs with no alert to start from, ending in a documented containment-scoping decision.
- *Tier 1 triage exercise:* dispositioned seven SIEM findings in a simulated shift, separating true positives from benign activity, with written justification for every escalate-or-close decision.

Security Lab Portfolio — *HTB Academy & Google Cybersecurity write-ups* akatetron.github.io/signal-over-noise

- **26 documented labs**, each with a designed walkthrough PDF: SIEM, Splunk, threat hunting with Elastic, IDS/IPS against real malware families, network traffic analysis, malware analysis, Windows attacks and defence, incident handling, plus 15 Google Cybersecurity labs.
- *Risk and threat modelling:* NIST SP 800-30 risk assessments, all seven PASTA stages applied to a payment application (data-flow diagram and attack tree), and an access-control review of a payroll breach recommending auto-expiry and MFA.

HANDS-ON SECURITY EXPERIENCE

Hack The Box — *continuous hands-on practice* 2021 – Present

- Approximately five years of offensive and defensive labs (machines, challenges and Sherlocks), verified by HTB Academy's **Half-Decade Hacksmith** badge. Academy profile DarkHexReaper: Level 36, rank Skilled.
- Completed 18 Academy modules end to end, including Detecting Windows Attacks with Splunk, YARA & Sigma for SOC Analysts, Intermediate Network Traffic Analysis, Introduction to Digital Forensics and Security Incident Reporting.
- Offensive practice (enumeration, exploitation and privilege escalation) applied directly to writing and tuning detections.
- Network investigations: traced SYN-flood DoS, malicious HTTP redirects, DNS failures and TCP anomalies from packet captures back to root cause.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Jewelry Associate — *TJX Canada (Winners / HomeSense / Marshalls), St. John's, NL* Sep 2023 – Sep 2026

- Customer service and cash handling in a high-footfall store with strict shift-handover procedures.
- Loss-prevention awareness and custody of high-value jewellery stock.
- Clear written and verbal communication with a diverse public.

Retail Associate — *Tirupati Jewelers, Udaipur, India · family business* Part-time

- Inventory and stock record-keeping, staff coordination and customer handling alongside schooling.
- Physical security for high-value goods: access control, custody tracking and reconciliation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (Computer Science) — *Memorial University of Newfoundland, St. John's* Sep 2023 – Nov 2027

Senior Secondary — Science, Mathematics & Computer Science — *St. Anthony's School, Udaipur* Mar 2021

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages	English (fluent, IELTS 6.5 / CEFR B2) · Hindi (native) · Polish (learning)
Work authorisation	Eligible to work in Canada (study permit). Indian citizen. Visa sponsorship required outside Canada and India.
Availability	Immediately · 24×7 rotational shifts · remote, hybrid or on-site